Get Dad's Records, Supplies, and Move Tasks Sorted Before the Date

Four prompts to list what the new provider has asked for, see what is confirmed versus assumed, share the work, and leave with a one-page readiness list.

Where you are

Dad is moving to a new care setting, or a new caregiver is starting at the house, and the date is close. Someone asked for “the paperwork” and you aren't sure what that includes or who is bringing the walker.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can say what has been requested, what is in hand, what is only assumed, and who is handling each piece.

A one-page readiness list: Requested by the provider, In hand, Still missing, Who is handling it, and Questions for the provider.

Before you start

- Any list or email from the new provider or agency about what they need.
- Your own notes on what Dad uses every day: medications, glasses, hearing aids, the walker, the chair he likes.
- The names of family members who have offered to help, even vaguely. You don't need the full picture yet.

PROMPT 1

Turn the provider's request into a plain checklist

WHY THIS MATTERS

The provider's list arrives as a form, a phone call, or a sentence at the end of an email. Until it is written in plain words, you can't tell what you have and what you don't.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The provider's list or email, or your notes from the call.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> A new care provider is about to start caring for my father. Here is what they have told us they need before the first day, in their words or as I remember it:
>
> [PASTE THE PROVIDER'S LIST OR YOUR NOTES FROM THE CALL]

> Rewrite this as a plain checklist in three groups: CARE INFORMATION (records, medication list, doctor contacts), PRACTICAL ITEMS (equipment, supplies, clothing, personal things), and PAPERWORK WE MUST SIGN OR BRING. Next to each item, mark CONFIRMED if they clearly asked for it or UNCLEAR if I am guessing. Then list the questions I should ask them to clear up anything marked UNCLEAR. Do not add items they did not mention.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The items marked UNCLEAR. Those are the ones that cause the last-minute scramble.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Call or email the provider with the UNCLEAR questions and write down the answers.

PROMPT 2

Separate what's arranged from what's assumed

WHY THIS MATTERS

Somebody said the hospital bed was ordered. Somebody heard the agency brings the supplies. Each of those is a sentence, not a delivery. The gap between them shows up on moving day.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on equipment, supplies, and transport, and who told you about each.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My father is moving to a new care arrangement soon. Here is everything I know about equipment, supplies, and getting him there:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a table with four columns: ITEM, WHO SAID IT WAS HANDLED, HOW I KNOW, and STATUS. For STATUS use only CONFIRMED, ASSUMED, or NOT DISCUSSED. Treat anything I only heard secondhand as ASSUMED. Then list the ASSUMED and NOT DISCUSSED items as short questions I can ask the provider, his doctor, or the equipment supplier. Do not tell me what equipment he needs or whether anything is safe for him. That is for his care team.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How many rows say ASSUMED. Each one is a phone call, not a problem.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Make the calls for the ASSUMED rows and change the status as you hear back.

PROMPT 3

Share the work before one person carries it

WHY THIS MATTERS

In most families, the tasks drift to whoever is closest or most organized. By the move date that person is exhausted and the others feel shut out.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The lists from the first two prompts, plus who can help and roughly how much time each has.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the tasks for my father's upcoming move, and here are the people who could help, with what I know about their time and location:
>
> [PASTE THE CHECKLISTS FROM PROMPTS 1 AND 2]
>
> [PASTE WHO CAN HELP AND THEIR LIMITS]
>
> Group the tasks into bundles that one person could reasonably own, such as paperwork, medications and records, belongings, transport, and talking with Dad. For each bundle, suggest an owner and a backup from the names I gave, based only on the limits I described. Flag any bundle where I have put myself as both owner and backup. Then draft a short message I could send to each person asking whether they will take it on, not telling them they have to.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Your own name appearing too often, and bundles with no backup.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send the messages and change the owner column as people reply.

PROMPT 4

Build your one-page readiness list

WHY THIS MATTERS

With a date approaching, you need something you can read in a minute and hand to a sibling. Not a binder. One page.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts, updated with the answers you've collected.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I have gathered about getting my father ready for his move:
>
> [PASTE THE UPDATED RESULTS FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Put it on one page with five headings: REQUESTED BY THE PROVIDER, IN HAND, STILL MISSING, WHO IS HANDLING IT, and QUESTIONS FOR THE PROVIDER. Under STILL MISSING, keep only items that are truly not arranged, and show the owner beside each. Keep the page to what I told you. Do not mark anything complete that I described as pending, and do not add advice about whether the move is a good idea.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page where every missing item has a name beside it.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Read it with the owners before the date. Keep it. It feeds the next step below.

Does the new team know who Dad is?

A readiness list tells you what to bring. The care interview organizes Dad's situation itself, area by area, into a Family Care Profile the new team can read and a professional can review.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›